

Social, Recreational & Community Participation

COMPREHENSIVE POLICY — HIQA COMPLIANT

1 PURPOSE

To promote and support the right of all residents to participate in meaningful social, recreational, and community-based activities that enhance quality of life, foster inclusion, promote wellbeing, and support independence and personal choice.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All service users, staff, management, and volunteers
- ✓ Group and individual recreational programmes; education, volunteering, employment access
- ✓ Community engagement, cultural events, outings, holidays, special occasions
- ✓ Partnerships with local organisations, clubs, and social services

3 PRINCIPLES

- ✓ **Person-Centred:** Based on individual interests, abilities, preferences, and support needs
- ✓ **Inclusion:** Supported to engage with wider community and form meaningful relationships
- ✓ **Empowerment:** Encouraged to set personal goals and participate in activity planning
- ✓ **Choice:** Right to decline participation without judgement or pressure
- ✓ **Diversity & Culture:** Activities reflect and respect cultural, religious, and personal backgrounds
- ✓ **Safety:** Risk-assessed with trained staff; **Equality:** Equal opportunities regardless of ability

4 ASSESSMENT & PLANNING

- ✓ Social/recreational needs assessed as part of holistic personal support plan
- ✓ Resident involvement in identifying goals and interests; keyworker input into scheduling
- ✓ Collaboration with families, advocates, and professionals; documented in personal plan/activity log
- ✓ Ongoing review and adjustment based on resident feedback and outcomes

5 EXAMPLES OF ACTIVITIES

- ✓ Arts & crafts, group games, music workshops, walks, picnics, nature outings
- ✓ Community events, theatre, cinema, social clubs, sports, drama groups
- ✓ Volunteering, part-time supported employment, life skills (shopping, budgeting, cooking)
- ✓ Cultural, religious, or seasonal celebrations; visits to library, café, gym

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SUPPORT, RESOURCES, RIGHTS & REVIEW

6 SUPPORT & SUPERVISION

- ✓ Supervision needs assessed within individual plan; named staff assigned for off-site/group activities
- ✓ Clear instructions, guidance, reassurance; sufficient staff ratios for safety and inclusion
- ✓ Gradual independence-building; dignity and privacy balanced with health & safety oversight

7 RESOURCES & TRANSPORT

- ✓ Budget allocation for materials, event entry, and activity expenses
- ✓ Accessible vehicles maintained to H&S standards; insurance and risk assessments in place
- ✓ Transport scheduled in advance; mobility/sensory support during travel
- ✓ Partnerships with community transport services explored; resources reviewed regularly

8 INCLUSION & RIGHTS

- ✓ Right to choose how to spend time; access local community services and facilities
- ✓ Right to build/maintain personal relationships; privacy, dignity, and autonomy during social experiences
- ✓ Staff actively address barriers (physical, attitudinal, financial) and advocate for full participation

9 MONITORING

- ✓ Activity plans reviewed during care plan reviews; participation documented in daily logs
- ✓ Resident/family feedback via meetings, surveys, keyworker check-ins
- ✓ Audits of activity schedules; analysis of participation trends and barriers to engagement

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or earlier if prompted by legislation, standards, or audits
- ✓ Consultation with residents, staff, management; review of participation data and incidents
- ✓ Revisions approved by senior management; superseded versions archived per document control